

...and so my watch has ended

I REMEMBER my first day at Digit as if it were yesterday. As a young, just-out-of-college finance graduate, I'd worn formals to work – something I soon realised no one does at Digit. I didn't have any tech educational background – just a love for gaming, peripherals, and technology in general. Having been disillusioned by the life of an analyst (excel sheets, financial models and pivot tables), I wanted to follow my passion. But quite frankly, I was intimidated when I stepped into this lair of tech geniuses. I'd been an on-and-off reader of the magazine since its Chip days (I still have a sizeable CD collection) and was quite thrilled when I was offered an internship at Digit. I was expecting a buzzing hive of activity in the legendary "Test Center" of Digit's Mumbai office. Instead what I saw was just one awkward looking employee (later revealed to be Rossi) typing away at his keyboard. "Where is everyone?" I remember asking, confused about all the insane gadgets lying around, but no people in sight. "We just closed the December issue and everyone is exhausted and sleeping at home". And thus I was innocuously introduced to the concept of *issue closing* – a fixture that would, for better or worse (mostly better), be at the center of my existence for the next nine years of my life. I didn't know it then, but every issue of the magazine you hold in your hands has the sweat (and sometimes blood, I wish I was kidding) of each and every member of the team. The sleepless nights during closing, the stress of missing a deadline, and the final huzzah of it all coming together at the end despite the unexpected setbacks – I'm going to miss it all.

Digit has always attracted the strangest of people and I'm proud to count myself amongst those weirdos. Over the years I saw many kindred spirits – wayward waifs, oddballs, and misfits to the world outside Digit – who beyond all their quirks and absurdities had one thing in common – a deep-rooted love for technology. Somewhere, I'd like to think that's what forged a bond between the people who worked here and our beloved readers.

As Digit evolved over the years, so did a unique culture that was quintessentially Digit. When you put a bunch of knowledgeable and passionate misfits in a quirky workplace cauldron, that peculiar magic is bound to happen.

Instead of beating these oddballs into submission or forcing them to conform, the work culture at Digit encourages offbeat thought processes. This is all thanks to the environment created and sustained by past editors, my bosses, and of course, the directors of the company. I'd like to believe that even I contributed to this distinct culture in a small way.

And now, after nearly nine years, my watch has come to an end. I take away nothing but treasured memories and valuable lessons. I'm truly thankful for having a boss like Robert. Sure, that came with its share of hair-pulling moments – and I emerged a winner there with slightly more hair left than Robert – but I'd never have it another way. I learned so much and encouragement was never in short supply. We may have argued, fought, but at the end of the day, we never lost sight of the goal. The culture he inculcated was one of supreme devotion to Digit and technology as a whole – a culture that still remains strong, even when he works from the other side of the world. All of these fun memories and valuable lessons, I'll keep with me forever.

So what next?

Just like the selection pressures of evolutionary biology, which Robert talks about on the next page, I need to induce some artificial pressures into my life in order to evolve. As they say "you cannot swim for new horizons until you have courage to lose sight of the shore". Perhaps I'll go on a *Eat Pray Love* type of soul-searching journey. There won't be much praying, but certainly a lot of the other two. Or maybe, this might turn out to be a mid-career gap year – the kind students take to crack an entrance exam. Whatever it is that I end up doing, the point is to feel awkward and uncomfortable again. To go back to being an oddball. What I'll never lose though is the love for tech, my inherent geekiness, and the strong work ethic that Digit has inculcated in me over the years. In that sense, I am a thorough Digit-wala.

While I am of course sad about leaving what has, for nine years, been my second home (maybe even my first one), I'm also happy in a strange sort of way. Because now, once again, I get to go back to being the most important member of the Digit family – a regular reader! 



"Over the years I saw many kindred spirits – wayward waifs, oddballs, and misfits to the world outside Digit – who beyond all their quirks and absurdities had one thing in common – a deep-rooted love for technology."



Reach me at:
facebook.com/
staticsid | @staticsid |
editor@digit.in